
Paper 2, Option 2A.2:

England and the Angevin Empire in the reign of Henry II, 1154–89

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of Henry II's restoration of royal power in England and the Angevin territories in the years 1154–89, after the anarchy of the civil war had dramatically weakened the power of the Anglo-Norman Kingdom.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the nature and extent of change in this period, and the ways in which Henry II restored, extended and maintained royal authority and power during his reign, and of the bitter rivalries that developed within the royal family.

Key topics	Content
1 The restoration and extension of royal authority, 1154–72	• England and the Angevin Empire in 1154: baronial power; declining royal revenues; the extent of Angevin lands overseas; the power of Eleanor of Aquitaine. • Henry II and the nobility: the destruction of illegal castles; the weakening of baronial power; the Cartae Baronum 1166; the Inquest of the Sheriffs 1170. • Wales, Scotland and Ireland: making peace in Wales; the submission of Malcolm IV; the submission of the Irish kings and bishops. • The Angevin lands in France: Henry's restoration of control in Normandy; acquisition and control of Brittany; relations and conflict with Louis VII of France; the significance of the peace of Montmirail.
2 Reforms in England, 1154–89	• Central institutions: the Curia Regis; the justiciars and the Chancellor; the roles of significant individuals, including Richard of Lucy, Bishop Nigel and Thomas Becket. • Financial reforms: the revival of the <i>Danegeld</i>; restoration of royal lands; reform of the coinage in 1158 and 1180; the importance of Richard fitzNigel; the impact of financial reforms on increasing royal income. • Legal reforms: the Assizes of Clarendon and Northampton; the itinerant justices and the general eyre; the Court of King's Bench; <i>novel disseisin</i> and <i>mort d'ancestor</i>; the extent of changes to the system of royal justice under Henry II and their implications for the power of the monarchy.

Key topics	Content
3 Henry II and the English church, 1154–74	- Henry's problems with the church: papal influence; church courts; the church's attitude towards moral offences; clerical interference in secular affairs. - Becket and the king, 1162–64: reasons for Becket's election as Archbishop of Canterbury; Henry's demands for reform; the Constitutions of Clarendon; Becket's attitude towards reform; conflict between king and archbishop; Becket's flight into exile. - The failure to compromise, 1169–70: the failure to reach a settlement; the diplomacy of Pope Alexander III; the coronation of the Young King in June 1170; Becket's return to England, his death and its significance, including its impact on the position of Henry II. - The settlements between king and church, 1172–74: the agreement at Avranches; relations between Henry and the pope; Henry's penance at Canterbury in 1174; the extent of Henry's success.
4 Crises of the Angevin Empire, 1170–89	- Power and family rivalries: Henry's plans for his sons' inheritance; the division of Angevin lands between Henry's sons; the position of Eleanor of Aquitaine. - Causes of the Great Rebellion of 1173–74: the opposition of the English barons to Henry's reforms; Henry's failure to grant his sons a role in government and their flight to Paris; Eleanor's opposition to the king. - The defeat of the Great Rebellion: Henry's victories in England and the Angevin lands; the expulsion of invaders from Normandy; the capture of William the Lion; the short-term impact of Henry's victories on royal power, 1174–80. - Philip Augustus and the collapse of Henry's power, 1180–89: the deaths of the Young King and Geoffrey; Richard and John's ambitions and treachery; the alliance of Philip and Richard against Henry; Henry's defeat in 1189.

Route B: Religion and the state in early modern Europe

Overview

Students taking Route B will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1B: England, 1509–1603: authority, nation and religion*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2B.1: Luther and the German Reformation, c1515–55*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2B.2: The Dutch Revolt, c1563–1609.*

The options in Route B are linked by the twin themes of religion and the state. The religious unity of medieval Christendom disintegrated during the sixteenth century, with repercussions for the centuries that followed. It was also a time when the authority of the secular state evolved throughout Europe and would lead England, the Netherlands and the German states down very different paths.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater appreciation of the nature of religion and state power in the early modern era and the similarities and contrasts between them (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).